



Date: January 15, 2025

To: MIT MSRP Program

From: Rahim Khoie, Ph.D.

Re: Zak Raymond, applicant for admission to MIT MSRP Program

Over the past several decades, I have written several recommendation letters to MIT Ph.D. programs for several truly outstanding students from University of Nevada, Las Vegas (UNLV), University of North Florida (UNF), and University of the Pacific (UOP). In this letter, I am writing about an undergraduate student of mine who is applying to your MSRP program, but I have no doubt, that he will be applying to one of your Ph.D. programs in the future.

I have known Zak for a very short time. He took my ECPE 41 Circuits class just this past Fall 2024. In spite of that, I have come to believe that he is truly an outstanding student. Although a bioengineering student, he outperformed all my electrical engineering, computer engineering, and mechanical engineering students. He scored a perfect 100% in my class, which is a rarity. But that's not it. He always asked questions during and after my lectures. And his questions were not: "Could you explain this phenomenon or that concept again?" No. His questions were: "Do the models we use to analyze circuits as you explain in this course truly describe their behavior?" "Is nature this linear?" In my conversations with him, it became obvious that he had a solid understanding of physics, far beyond that of an undergraduate student, with his chemistry and mathematics background just as strong.

What I have observed from Zak, over such short period of time, makes me confident that he has the potential, the deep desire, the passion, the persistence, and perseverance of becoming a great scientist, and attending MIT MSRP program is only the first step in his pursuit of excellence in science. He also has a great disposition and interacting with him is joyful.

I strongly recommend him.

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Rahim Khoie". The signature is stylized with a large, sweeping "R" and a long, horizontal line extending to the right.

Rahim Khoie, Ph.D.

Professor, Electrical and Computer Engineering,

Former Director, Engineering Physics Program

Former Chair, University Academic Council

University of the Pacific